

Bill Spencer

From: Bill Spencer
Sent: Wednesday, October 12, 2016 4:20 PM
To: Coronado, Mark A
Cc: Adam Morasch; Mary Christen; Adam Fyall
Subject: PILT Benton County
Attachments: PILT Assessed Values Table Mark Coronado.xlsx

Mark,

Thank you for your patience. Attached is the spreadsheet you provided to us with your request for value and tax amounts for Benton County excluding the value of Hanford. We were able to provide the number of acres and market value for most categories, unfortunately, we are not able to provide all of the information that you have requested. We have found that in our current software system, it is not possible to do queries in past years based on the requested criteria. Each year queries were performed to find the necessary information for the PILT calculations and those results in most cases were saved. However, those queries were based on the specifications set forth in the PILT agreement and do not contain the information that you are requesting. We have attempted to recreate those queries with the aid of the county IT Department and have found that those searches cannot be recreated. Therefore, our information is limited to the original search results which only provide the total acres and market value of most classifications.

To explain further, the PILT agreement is based on land types. Although our appraisal system is able to provide the information needed for the PILT calculation by land type, the taxing system is not. Currently, the Benton County Assessor's office and Treasurer's office operate on two systems, one for appraisal information which supplies the values and one for taxing purposes. It is not possible to query in the taxing system by land type. Although this is frustrating it is an improvement over the system in place before the year 2000. You will notice on the spreadsheet that there are no values for 1999. At that time, the county's IT Department provided the acreage and value information to the Assessor's office in writing. We were only able to find those records starting with the 2003 tax year.

You'll also notice that the information for riverfront is not filled in and it is also because of system limitations. The assessment of \$50.00 per linear foot for lesser riverfront has not changed since 1996 and is applied to the agreed upon amount of lesser riverfront, which is 128,978 linear feet. The premium riverfront assessment of \$1,965 has been the value used since 2009 and is applied to 30,672 linear feet, the amount agreed upon in the settlement agreement.

This explanation does not help you much now. However, it has helped our office to see how we can improve this process moving forward to retain accurate and consistent records and be able to account to your department the information that you request.

Thanks,



Bill Spencer

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